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ASSIGNMENT 2

Deep Learning and Its Applications (CO3133)

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1 Problem and Data Description

1.1 Problem Formulation

- **Real-world motivation:** Per-pixel distance from a single camera is a core input for robot navigation, AR occlusion, autonomous driving and 3D scene reconstruction, where LiDAR or stereo rigs are expensive or unavailable. A single RGB image does not determine metric depth uniquely, so the network has to infer distance from learned cues (perspective, texture gradients, object size, occlusion boundaries). Studying this on a dataset that mixes short-range indoor rooms (1–9 m) and long-range outdoor scenes (up to 200 m) exposes how well a model and its training protocol transfer across very different depth ranges.
- **Input:** One RGB image $I \in \mathbb{R}^{3\times 288\times 384}$ (ImageNet-normalised).
- **Output:** A dense depth map $\hat{D} \in \mathbb{R}_{>0}^{1\times 288\times 384}$ in metres. The pretrained model predicts *relative inverse depth* (disparity up to an unknown scale and shift), which is converted to metres by per-image alignment (§2.2.4).
- **Prediction unit:** One depth value per pixel; metrics are computed per image on valid pixels and then averaged over images.
- **Ground truth:** Laser-scanner depth D^* with a binary validity mask $M \in \{0,1\}^{288\times 384}$; loss and metrics use only pixels with $M = 1$.
- **Mathematical formulation:** Given $\mathcal{D}_{\text{train}} = \{(I_i, D_i^*, M_i)\}_{i=1}^N$, learn f_θ minimising a masked per-image loss

$$\theta^* = \arg\min_\theta \frac{1}{N}\sum_{i=1}^{N} \mathcal{L}\big(f_\theta(I_i), D_i^*, M_i\big),$$

  where $\mathcal{L}$ is the scale-invariant log loss for the metric U-Net and the scale-and-shift-invariant loss for MiDaS (§2.2).
- **Main difficulties:**
  1. **Scale ambiguity:** a small close object and a large distant one can project to the same pixels; metric scale must be inferred from context.
  2. **Domain gap within the dataset:** indoor median depth 2.6 m vs outdoor 6.3 m (train), with outdoor p99 at 74.8 m.
  3. **Sparse, noisy outdoor ground truth:** sky, foliage, glass and edges produce dropouts; outdoor images have on average 31.4 % invalid pixels in train and 47.4 % in the validation scene.
  4. **Few scenes per split:** a scene-level split is necessary to avoid leakage but leaves one indoor and one outdoor scene each for validation and test.

1.2 Dataset Description

Item	Value
Name / source	DIODE — Dense Indoor and Outdoor DEpth (Vasiljevic et al., 2019), https://diode-dataset.org
Version	Original 2019 release (25,458 train + 771 val images) obtained from the Kaggle mirror `artemmmtry/diode-a-dense-indoor-and-outdoor-depth-dataset`, Kaggle version 8 (199.89 GB). Not DIODEv2.
License	MIT (upstream site, official devkit, and Kaggle mirror all state MIT)
Collection / labelling	FARO Focus S350 laser scanner co-registered with RGB; depth in metres; validity mask marks pixels with a laser return. No manual labelling.
Annotation type	Dense per-pixel metric depth + binary validity mask
Used subset	**7,195 RGB–depth pairs** from 15 scenes (4,995 train / 1,100 val / 1,100 test)
Storage (subset)	≈ 2.5 GB: RGB as JPEG (quality 90), depth as `float16 .npy`, mask as `uint8 .npy`, all 384×288
Bias / limitations	Only level-to-upward camera tilts (vertical codes 000–050), no downward views; outdoor scenes are campus buildings and vegetation; the three splits come from the official training partition, so numbers are not comparable to the public DIODE benchmark.

1.3 Exploratory Data Analysis

Representative samples. Figure 1 shows RGB, depth and validity mask for random training samples. Indoor invalid pixels form thin outlines around object contours (laser drop-out at sharp edges); outdoor invalid regions are dominated by sky and fine branches.

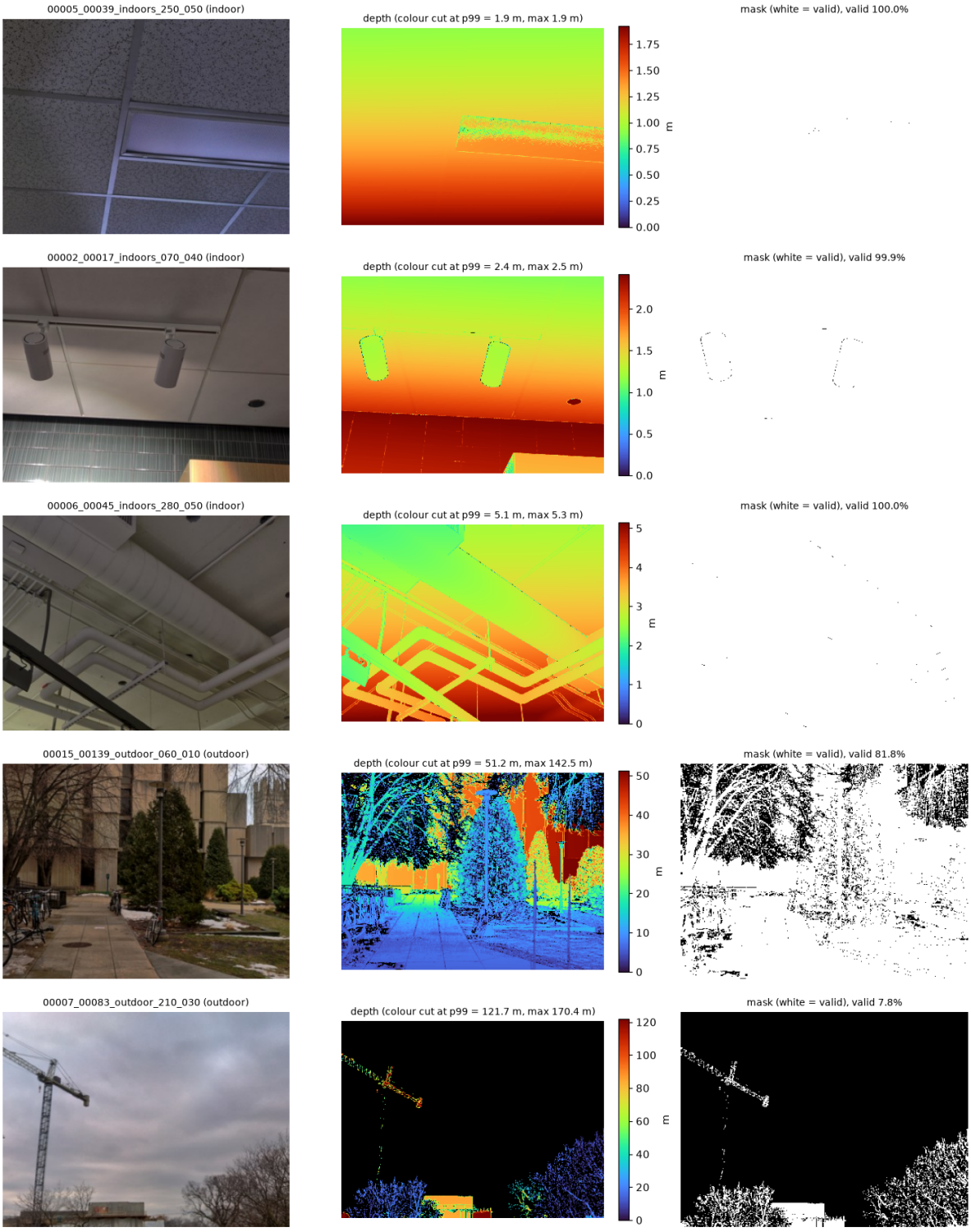


Figure 1: Five random training samples — RGB, depth (blue near, red far, black invalid, colour scale capped at the 99th percentile) and validity mask.

Depth and invalid-pixel distribution (Table 1, Figures 2–3). Statistics are over all valid pixels per split and domain; *invalid %* is the per-image mean.

Table 1: Depth distribution and invalid-pixel rate per split.

Split	Domain	Images	p5 (m)	Median (m)	p95 (m)	p99 (m)	Mean invalid %
train	indoor	2,606	1.0	2.6	9.0	20.2	0.8
train	outdoor	2,389	1.2	6.3	37.6	74.8	31.4
val	indoor	700	0.6	1.3	3.5	6.4	0.2
val	outdoor	400	1.4	7.1	32.5	51.4	47.4
test	indoor	700	0.8	1.8	5.0	7.5	0.2
test	outdoor	400	2.1	8.3	46.3	84.6	33.2

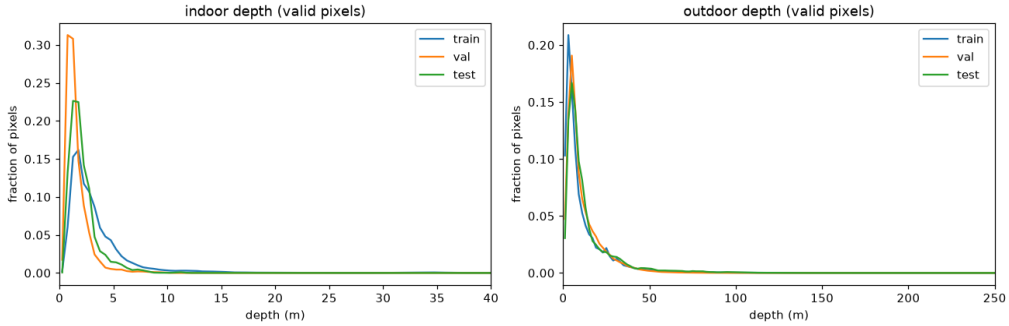


Figure 2: Distribution of valid depth values per split.

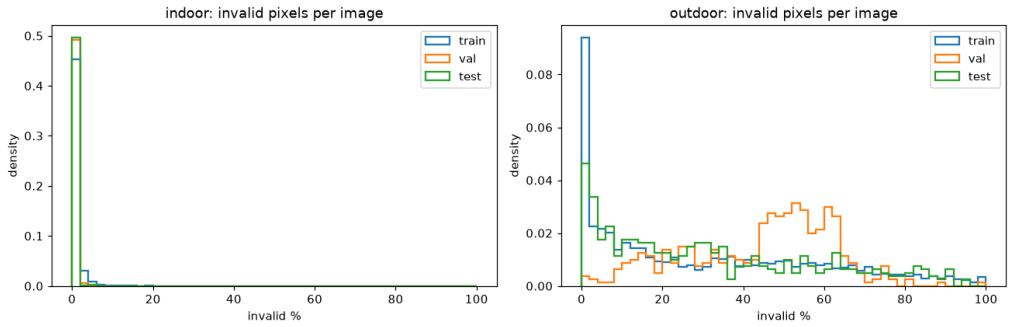


Figure 3: Distribution of per-image invalid-pixel percentage per split.

Key observations:

- **Depth range differs by an order of magnitude** between domains, which motivates reporting indoor and outdoor separately in every table.
- **Validation indoor scene is unusually close** (median 1.3 m vs 2.6 m in train). A metric model that learns the training depth prior will over-estimate depth there (observed in §3.2).
- **Outliers:** only 0.0085 % of indoor valid pixels exceed 50 m and 0.0051 % of outdoor valid pixels exceed 200 m; these are treated as sensor noise and masked. Readings below 0.6 m (the scanner's minimum range, ≈ 0.3 % of outdoor pixels, mostly leaves and glass) are also masked.

- **Camera tilt (Figure 4):** every scene contains vertical codes 000–050; 26–42 % of images per scene look upward (code $\geq$ 040), which increases the sky share in outdoor images.

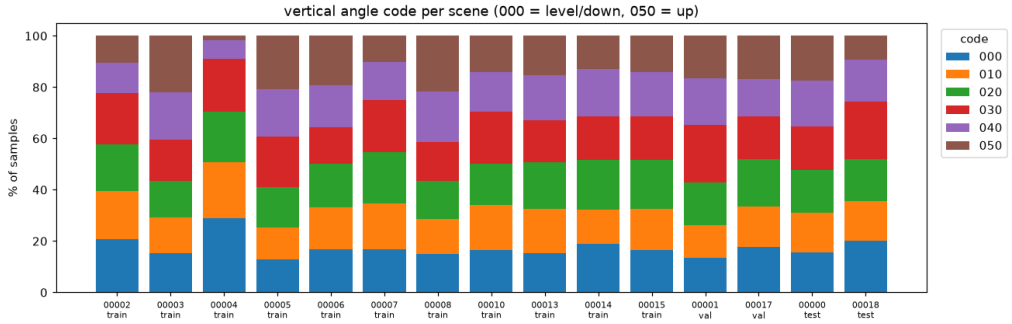


Figure 4: Distribution of vertical camera-tilt codes per scene.

1.4 Data Splitting

- **Split unit: scene.** DIODE scans of the same scene share geometry and viewpoints; all images of a scene go to exactly one split. Overlap between splits was verified to be 0 scenes (`proposal/scenes_used.csv`).
- **Custom split** (DIODE has no public test labels): $\approx$ 70 / 15 / 15 % by images with seed 42.

Table 2: Scene-level split.

Split	Indoor scenes (images)	Outdoor scenes (images)	Total
train	00002 (700), 00003 (466), 00004 (400), 00005 (340), 00006 (700)	00007 (389), 00008, 00010, 00013, 00014, 00015 (400 each)	4,995 (2,606 / 2,389)
val	00001 (700)	00017 (400)	1,100 (700 / 400)
test	00000 (700)	00018 (400)	1,100 (700 / 400)

- **Subset selection rule:** at most 700 images per indoor scene and 400 per outdoor scene, sampled with seed 42, so that no single large scene dominates. No stratification beyond the indoor/outdoor balance per split.
- **Leakage prevention:** scene-disjoint splits; checkpoint selection uses only the validation split; the test split was evaluated once per final checkpoint, after all design decisions were fixed.

1.5 Preprocessing

- **Resize:** 1024 $\times$ 768 $\rightarrow$ 384 $\times$ 288. RGB with bilinear interpolation; depth and mask with **nearest neighbour**. DIODE encodes invalid depth as 0, so bilinear resizing would blend zeros into valid boundary pixels. We verified the stored subset: mask

values are strictly $\{0, 1\}$ and the border-to-interior depth median ratio is 0.81–1.03 (vs < 0.5 under bilinear blending).

- **Validity mask:** `valid = mask > 0` $\wedge$ finite $\wedge$ $0.6\,\text{m} \leq$ depth $\leq$ cap, with cap 50 m indoor and 200 m outdoor. Invalid pixels are set to 0 and excluded from loss and metrics.
- **Normalisation:** RGB scaled to $[0, 1]$ and normalised with ImageNet mean/std; depth kept in metres.
- **Augmentation:** synchronous random horizontal flip ($p = 0.5$) of RGB, depth and mask, training only. No colour or scale augmentation (scale changes would alter metric depth).
- **Tensor shapes:** RGB $(B, 3, 288, 384)$ float32, depth $(B, 1, 288, 384)$ float32, mask $(B, 1, 288, 384)$ in $\{0, 1\}$; $B = 8$. Figure 5 shows one real training batch after preprocessing.

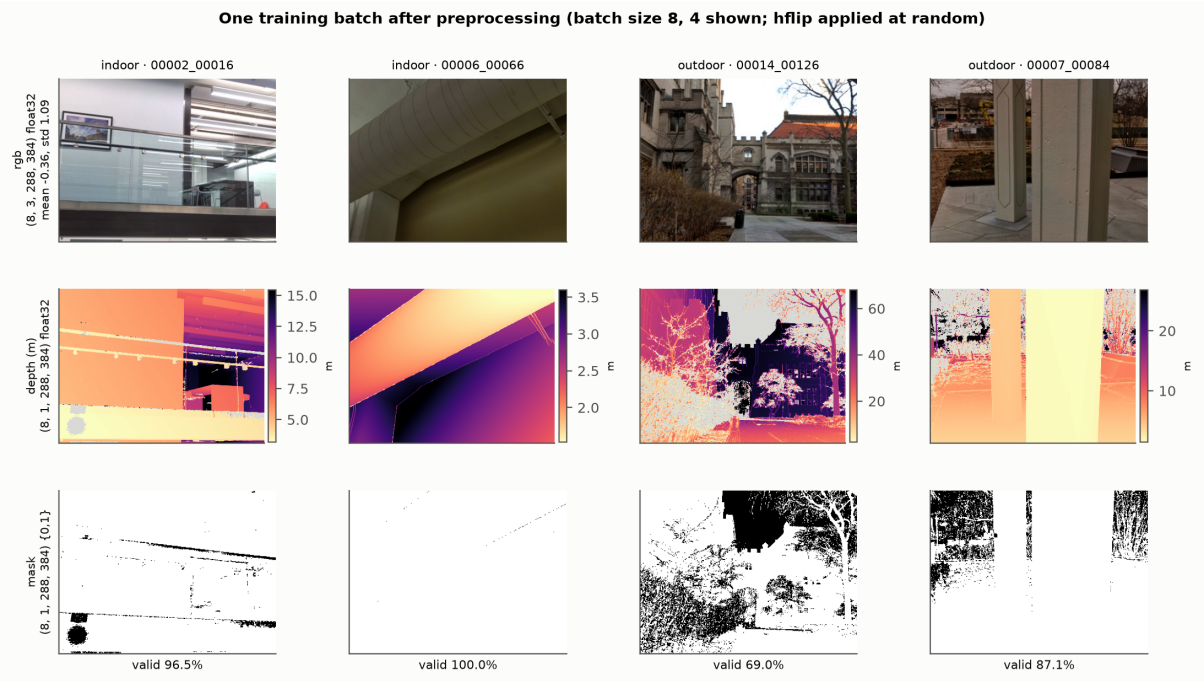


Figure 5: One training batch after preprocessing (4 of 8 shown): normalised RGB, depth in metres (grey = invalid), and validity mask with its valid-pixel share.

2 Methodology

2.1 Pipeline Overview

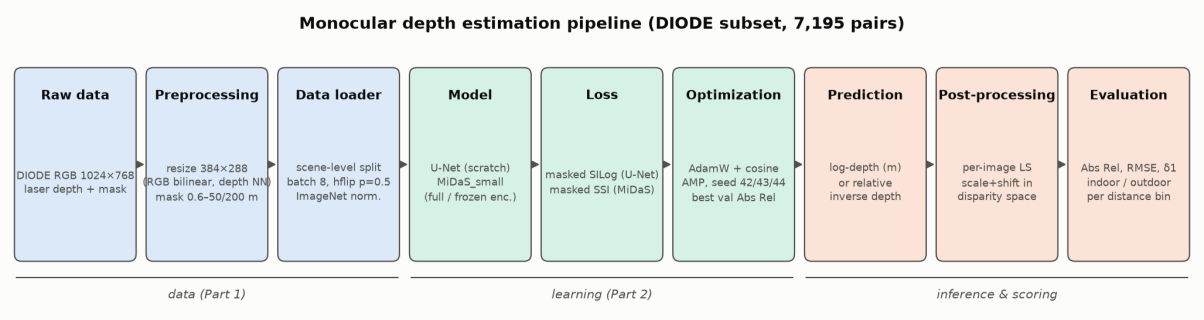


Figure 6: End-to-end pipeline — raw data, preprocessing, data loader, model, loss, optimisation, prediction, post-processing (scale/shift alignment), evaluation.

1. **Raw data:** DIODE RGB (1024 × 768), laser depth and validity mask.
2. **Preprocessing:** resize to 384×288 (nearest neighbour for depth/mask), range masking 0.6–50 m / 0.6–200 m.
3. **Data loader:** scene-level splits, batch 8, horizontal flips, ImageNet norm., and seeded workers.
4. **Model:** U-Net trained from scratch (metric log-depth) or MiDaS_small (relative inverse depth), the latter either fully fine-tuned or with a frozen encoder.
5. **Loss:** masked SILog (U-Net) or masked scale-and-shift-invariant loss (MiDaS).
6. **Optimisation:** AdamW + cosine schedule, mixed precision; checkpoint = epoch with lowest overall val Abs Rel.
7. **Prediction:** forward pass at 384 × 288.
8. **Post-processing:** per-image least-squares scale and shift in disparity space (applied to every model for the main comparison).
9. **Evaluation:** Abs Rel, RMSE, δ_1 per image on valid pixels; reported overall, per domain, and per distance bin.

2.2 Baseline and Main Methods

2.2.1 Baseline — U-Net trained from scratch

- **Architecture:** 4-level encoder–decoder; each level is two (Conv 3 × 3 → BatchNorm → ReLU) blocks with channels 32 → 64 → 128 → 256 → 512 (bottleneck at 1/16 resolution, 18 × 24); 2 × 2 max-pooling down, 2 × 2 transposed convolution up, skip concatenation at each level; 1 × 1 output head.

- **Output:** log-depth z; depth $= \exp(\text{clamp}(z, -7, 6))$ (≈ 1 mm to 400 m). The head bias is initialised to 1.6 (≈ 5 m). An exponential instead of ReLU keeps gradients alive for all pixels.
- **Loss — masked SILog** (Eigen et al., 2014), with $d_p = \log \hat{D}_p - \log D_p^*$ over the n valid pixels:
$$\mathcal{L}_{\text{SILog}} = \frac{1}{n}\sum_p d_p^2 - \lambda\Big(\frac{1}{n}\sum_p d_p\Big)^2, \qquad \lambda = 0.5.$$
The log is computed in float32 even under AMP.
- **Parameters:** 7.76 M (all trainable).
- **Strengths / limits:** predicts metric depth directly and is fast (3.3 ms/image), but has no prior knowledge of scene geometry and only 11 training scenes to learn it from.

2.2.2 Pretrained model — MiDaS_small

- **Architecture:** EfficientNet-Lite3 encoder pretrained on ImageNet and then trained by the MiDaS authors on a large mixture of depth datasets; RefineNet-style multi-scale fusion decoder. Loaded from `torch.hub` (`intel-isl/MiDaS`, `MiDaS_small`).
- **Output:** relative inverse depth (disparity), defined only up to an unknown scale and shift.
- **Parameters:** 21.32 M total; with a frozen encoder 14.90 M remain trainable (encoder 6.42 M frozen).
- **Fine-tuning loss — masked scale-and-shift-invariant (SSI) loss** (Ranftl et al., 2020). Prediction $\hat{u}$ and target disparity $u^* = 1/D^*$ are each normalised per image on valid pixels,
$$\tilde{x} = \frac{x - \text{median}(x)}{\frac{1}{n}\sum_p |x_p - \text{median}(x)|}, \qquad \mathcal{L}_{\text{SSI}} = \frac{1}{n}\sum_p \big|\tilde{\hat{u}}_p - \tilde{u}_p^*\big|,$$
then averaged over the images of the batch (images with < 10 valid pixels are skipped).
- **Strengths / limits:** strong geometric prior from large-scale pretraining; cannot output metric depth without alignment.

2.2.3 Fine-tuning protocol

- **Zero-shot:** pretrained weights, no training on DIODE.
- **Full fine-tune:** all 21.32 M parameters trained.
- **Frozen encoder:** encoder parameters are frozen; encoder BatchNorm stays in eval mode without updating running statistics, and only the decoder trains.
- Both fine-tuning variants use identical hyper-parameters (§2.3), so the encoder freezing is the only changed factor.

2.2.4 Alignment for evaluation (post-processing)

For every image and every model we fit a least-squares scale s and shift t in disparity space on valid pixels,

$$(s,t) = \arg\min_{s,t} \sum_{p \in \text{valid}} \big(s\,\hat{u}_p + t - 1/D_p^*\big)^2, \qquad \hat{D} = \frac{1}{\text{clip}\big(s\,\hat{u} + t,\ 1/\text{cap},\ 10^3\big)}.$$

The U-Net's metric output is converted to disparity $1/\hat{D}$ before alignment so that all models are compared under the same protocol; its raw metric results are reported separately. Alignment uses ground truth, so aligned numbers measure *relative* depth quality (structure), not absolute scale.

2.2.5 Metrics

Per image on valid pixels, then averaged over images ($\hat{D}$ clipped into the valid range instead of dropping bad pixels):

- **Abs Rel** (primary): $\frac{1}{n}\sum_p |\hat{D}_p - D_p^*|/D_p^* \downarrow$
- **RMSE (m):** $\sqrt{\frac{1}{n}\sum_p (\hat{D}_p - D_p^*)^2} \downarrow$
- $\boldsymbol{\delta_1}$**:** share of pixels with $\max(\hat{D}_p/D_p^*,\ D_p^*/\hat{D}_p) < 1.25 \uparrow$

Sanity checks (`tests/test_metrics.py`): feeding GT gives Abs Rel = RMSE = 0 and $\delta_1 = 100\,\%$; a disparity map scaled and shifted from $1/D^*$ is recovered exactly by the alignment.

2.2.6 Self-implemented vs library code

- **Self-implemented:** subset builder and scene split, Dataset/DataLoader with masking, U-Net, SILog and SSI losses, least-squares alignment, metrics and distance-bin tracker, trainer (AMP, checkpointing, time budget, VRAM logging), evaluation and all diagnostic/figure scripts, unit tests.
- **Libraries:** PyTorch 2.14 (layers, optimizer, scheduler, AMP), MiDaS_small via torch.hub (MiDaS repository), timm and gen-efficientnet-pytorch (EfficientNet-Lite3), OpenCV, NumPy, Pillow, Matplotlib and PyYAML.

2.3 Training Setup

Table 3: Training configuration (`configs/base.yaml` + one YAML per experiment).

Setting	U-Net baseline	MiDaS full FT	MiDaS frozen encoder
Optimizer	AdamW, wd 1e-4	AdamW, wd 1e-4	AdamW, wd 1e-4
Learning rate	3e-4	5e-5	5e-5
Scheduler	cosine to 0 over the run	cosine	cosine
Batch size	8	8	8
Epochs	max 40, 60-min time budget	10	10
Loss	masked SILog ($\lambda = 0.5$)	masked SSI	masked SSI
Regularisation	weight decay, hflip	weight decay, hflip, pretrained init	weight decay, hflip, frozen encoder + BN
Early stopping	none (time budget only)	none	none
Checkpoint rule	lowest overall val Abs Rel	same	same
Mixed precision	AMP fp16 (loss in fp32)	AMP	AMP
Seeds	42, 43, 44	42, 43, 44	42, 43, 44

- **Determinism:** Python/NumPy/PyTorch seeds and DataLoader workers are seeded; cuDNN benchmarking is disabled and deterministic algorithms are enabled. Two smoke runs produced identical losses and metrics.
- **Hardware / software:** NVIDIA GeForce RTX 4060 Laptop GPU (8 GB); Python 3.14.8, PyTorch 2.14.0 + CUDA 13.0, cuDNN 9.24, timm 1.0.30, NumPy 2.5.3.
- **Training time (seed 42):** U-Net 52.0 min (40 epochs, 78 s/epoch); MiDaS full FT 35.6 min (214 s/epoch); frozen encoder 30.1 min (180 s/epoch).
- **Hyper-parameter selection:** no grid search (compute budget). MiDaS lr 5e-5 is the usual fine-tuning range for a pretrained depth network; the U-Net lr 3e-4 is the standard Adam range for training from scratch. Ten MiDaS epochs were chosen from the M1 compute estimate; val Abs Rel had flattened by epoch 7–9 (Figure 7).
- **Compute estimate vs actual:** the M1 benchmark predicted ≈ 1.0 min/epoch for MiDaS_small (AMP, L1 placeholder loss, no validation). The actual 3.6 min/epoch is slower because of deterministic cuDNN, the per-image SSI loss and a full aligned validation pass every epoch.

2.4 Experimental Design

Table 4: Experiments.

#	Experiment	Hypothesis	Changed factor	Fixed factors	Metrics	Decision criterion
E1	Baseline vs pretrained	Large-scale depth pretraining gives better structure than training from scratch on 11 scenes	Model (U-Net scratch vs MiDaS)	data, split, alignment, metrics	aligned Abs Rel, RMSE, δ_1 (val + test), compute	lower test Abs Rel in both domains
E2	Zero-shot vs fine-tuned	Fine-tuning on DIODE adapts MiDaS to laser GT and these scenes	Training on DIODE (none vs full FT)	model, data, alignment	same	lower test Abs Rel than zero-shot in both domains
E3 (controlled, main ablation)	**Full FT vs frozen encoder**	Updating the encoder lets features adapt, so full FT reaches lower val Abs Rel	`freeze_encoder` only	data, split, SSI loss, AdamW lr 5e-5 wd 1e-4, cosine, batch 8, 10 epochs, AMP, checkpoint rule, alignment	overall val Abs Rel (primary), test Abs Rel, RMSE, δ_1, train time, VRAM	full FT is better only if its mean val Abs Rel is lower than frozen by more than the seed-to-seed std (3 seeds: 42, 43, 44); otherwise the cheaper frozen setup is preferred
E4	Evaluation-protocol ablations	(a) Outdoor error is partly a GT-boundary artefact; (b) a robust median/MAD alignment is better than least squares on outdoor scenes	(a) valid-mask erosion 0/1/2 px; (b) LS vs median/MAD alignment	trained checkpoints	Abs Rel per domain	(a) supported if outdoor Abs Rel drops much more than indoor; (b) adopt median alignment only if lower Abs Rel on both domains

3 Implementation Results

3.1 Training Behaviour

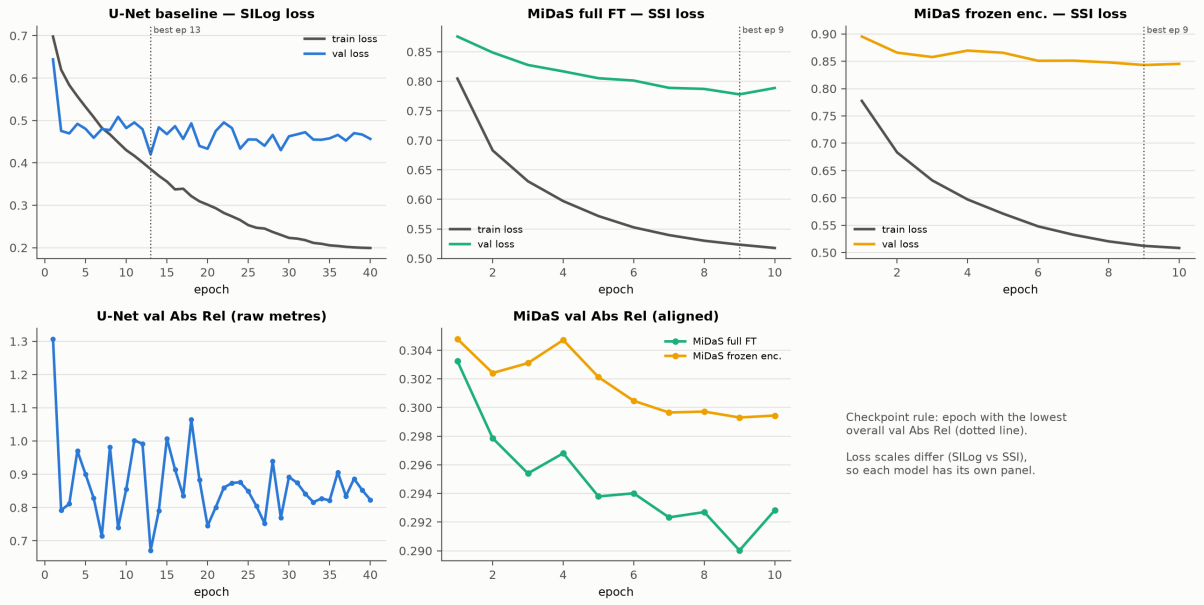


Figure 7: Training and validation loss per model (top) and validation Abs Rel per epoch (bottom; U-Net raw metres, MiDaS aligned). Dotted lines mark the selected checkpoint.

- **U-Net:** training loss falls steadily from 0.70 to 0.20 over 40 epochs while validation loss plateaus after epoch 2 and oscillates between 0.42 and 0.51. Raw val Abs Rel is very noisy (0.67–1.31) and is lowest at **epoch 13 of 40**, so the baseline overfits the 11 training scenes; the late epochs are not used.
- **MiDaS full FT:** validation loss decreases monotonically until epoch 9 (0.778) and rises slightly at epoch 10; val Abs Rel 0.303 → 0.290 (best epoch 9).
- **MiDaS frozen encoder:** validation loss barely moves (0.896 → 0.843) and val Abs Rel improves only 0.305 → 0.299 (best epoch 9). With the encoder fixed, the decoder alone has limited room to change the representation.
- **Implementation issues found and fixed:** (i) bilinear depth resizing in the first subset contaminated valid boundary pixels with zero depth → the subset was rebuilt with nearest-neighbour resizing (M1); (ii) sub-0.6 m outdoor readings pushed zero-shot outdoor Abs Rel above 1 → depths below the scanner's minimum range are masked (M2).
- **Design safeguards:** the U-Net predicts log-depth with an exponential output because a ReLU would give zero gradient to pixels stuck at 0; the SILog logarithm is computed in fp32 because fp16 under AMP loses precision; in the frozen-encoder variant the encoder's BatchNorm layers are kept in eval mode so their running statistics do not drift.

3.2 Quantitative Results

Table 5: Main results, seed 42 (aligned unless stated). Val = scenes 00001 (indoor) + 00017 (outdoor); test = 00000 + 00018, 700 indoor + 400 outdoor images each.

		Overall			Indoor		Outdoor		
Split	Model	Abs Rel ↓	RMSE ↓	δ_1 ↑	Abs Rel ↓	δ_1 ↑	Abs Rel ↓	RMSE ↓	δ_1 ↑
val	U-Net (raw metres)	0.671	4.77	31.9 %	0.606	38.1 %	0.785	11.26	21.2 %
val	U-Net (aligned)	0.338	4.43	58.0 %	0.165	77.4 %	0.641	11.21	24.0 %
val	MiDaS zero-shot	0.321	4.60	63.2 %	0.132	83.9 %	0.651	11.79	26.9 %
val	MiDaS full FT	**0.290**	4.39	**68.1 %**	**0.091**	**92.4 %**	0.637	11.26	25.6 %
val	MiDaS frozen enc.	0.299	**4.34**	66.3 %	0.106	89.6 %	**0.637**	**11.11**	25.5 %
test	U-Net (raw metres)	0.561	6.18	25.7 %	0.436	28.8 %	0.780	14.93	20.2 %
test	U-Net (aligned)	0.305	5.35	59.0 %	0.177	73.1 %	0.531	13.48	34.5 %
test	MiDaS zero-shot	0.271	5.11	67.8 %	0.126	83.9 %	0.524	13.17	39.5 %
test	MiDaS full FT	**0.232**	4.52	**72.7 %**	**0.096**	**89.8 %**	0.470	11.63	42.9 %
test	MiDaS frozen enc.	0.233	**4.44**	72.6 %	0.099	89.5 %	**0.467**	**11.42**	**43.0 %**

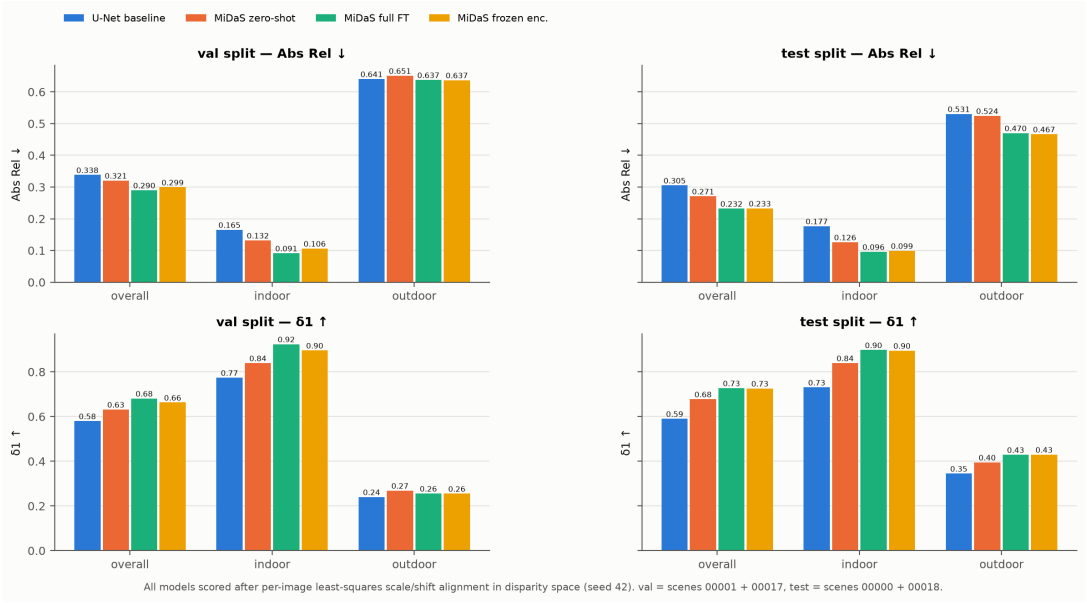


Figure 8: Abs Rel (top) and δ_1 (bottom) per domain on val and test, seed 42, all models aligned.

Table 6: U-Net baseline over three seeds (42 / 43 / 44), Abs Rel mean ± sample std. Best val epochs 13 / 16 / 19 of 40; training 52.0 / 50.7 / 50.9 min.

Split	Mode	Overall Abs Rel	Overall δ_1	Indoor Abs Rel	Outdoor Abs Rel
val	raw metres	0.653 ± 0.017	29.2 ± 3.1 %	0.608 ± 0.009	0.730 ± 0.048
val	aligned	0.341 ± 0.004	57.5 ± 1.0 %	0.169 ± 0.007	0.642 ± 0.002
test	raw metres	0.554 ± 0.019	26.2 ± 0.8 %	0.459 ± 0.044	0.721 ± 0.055
test	aligned	0.306 ± 0.005	59.0 ± 1.0 %	0.177 ± 0.005	0.531 ± 0.004

The seed-42 numbers in Table 5 are representative: aligned test Abs Rel varies by only ±0.005 *across seeds, far less than the 0.035 gap to MiDaS zero-shot. Raw metric error*

varies about 4× more than aligned error, mainly from the global scale the network learns.

Table 7: Controlled experiment E3 over three seeds (aligned Abs Rel, mean ± sample std).

Split	Domain	Full FT (seed 42 / 43 / 44)	Full FT mean ± std	Frozen (seed 42 / 43 / 44)	Frozen mean ± std	Gap (frozen − full)
val	**overall**	0.2900 / 0.2883 / 0.2898	**0.2893 ± 0.0010**	0.2993 / 0.3001 / 0.2989	0.2994 ± 0.0006	**+0.0101**
val	indoor	0.0915 / 0.0914 / 0.0897	0.0909 ± 0.0010	0.1064 / 0.1048 / 0.1048	0.1053 ± 0.0009	+0.0144
val	outdoor	0.6375 / 0.6327 / 0.6398	0.6367 ± 0.0036	0.6369 / 0.6420 / 0.6385	0.6392 ± 0.0026	+0.0025
test	**overall**	0.2321 / 0.2291 / 0.2319	**0.2310 ± 0.0017**	0.2328 / 0.2340 / 0.2333	0.2334 ± 0.0006	**+0.0024**
test	indoor	0.0961 / 0.0935 / 0.0931	0.0943 ± 0.0016	0.0992 / 0.0995 / 0.0995	0.0994 ± 0.0001	+0.0051
test	outdoor	0.4701 / 0.4664 / 0.4746	0.4704 ± 0.0041	0.4667 / 0.4694 / 0.4676	0.4679 ± 0.0014	−0.0025

Sample std over 3 seeds. Training of seeds 43 / 44: full FT 36.0 / 33.8 min (best epoch 6 / 10), frozen 29.6 / 29.5 min (best epoch 10 / 7); peak VRAM identical to seed 42 (2.42 GB full, 1.17 GB frozen).

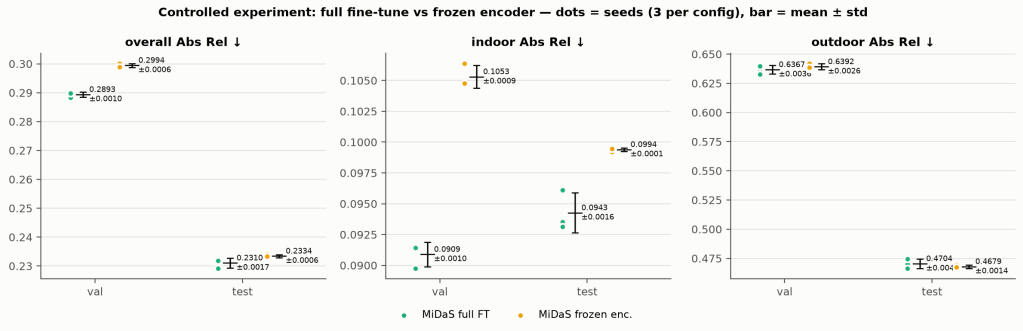


Figure 9: Controlled experiment — each dot is one seed; bars show mean ± std.

Table 8: Compute cost (seed 42). Inference is model-only, batch 1, AMP, 100 images after 10 warm-up passes; whole-split evaluation including alignment takes ≈ 13–14 s for 1,100 images.

Model	Params (M)	Trainable (M)	Epochs (best)	Train time (min)	s / epoch	Peak train VRAM (GB)	Inference (ms/img)
U-Net baseline	7.76	7.76	40 (13)	52.0	78	1.40	3.3
MiDaS zero-shot	21.32	0	–	–	–	–	9.4 – 9.9
MiDaS full FT	21.32	21.32	10 (9)	35.6	214	2.42	10.1 – 10.4
MiDaS frozen enc.	21.32	14.90	10 (9)	30.1	180	1.17	10.8 – 11.3

Ranges are the val and test measurements. The three MiDaS variants run the same network at inference, so their 9.4–11.3 ms spread is timing noise on a laptop GPU, not a real difference.

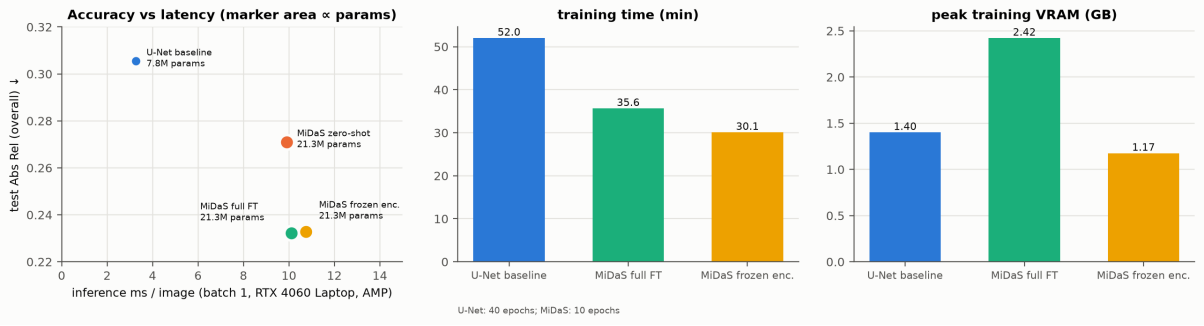


Figure 10: Accuracy vs latency (left, marker area $\propto$ parameters), training time and peak training VRAM (right).

3.3 Qualitative Results

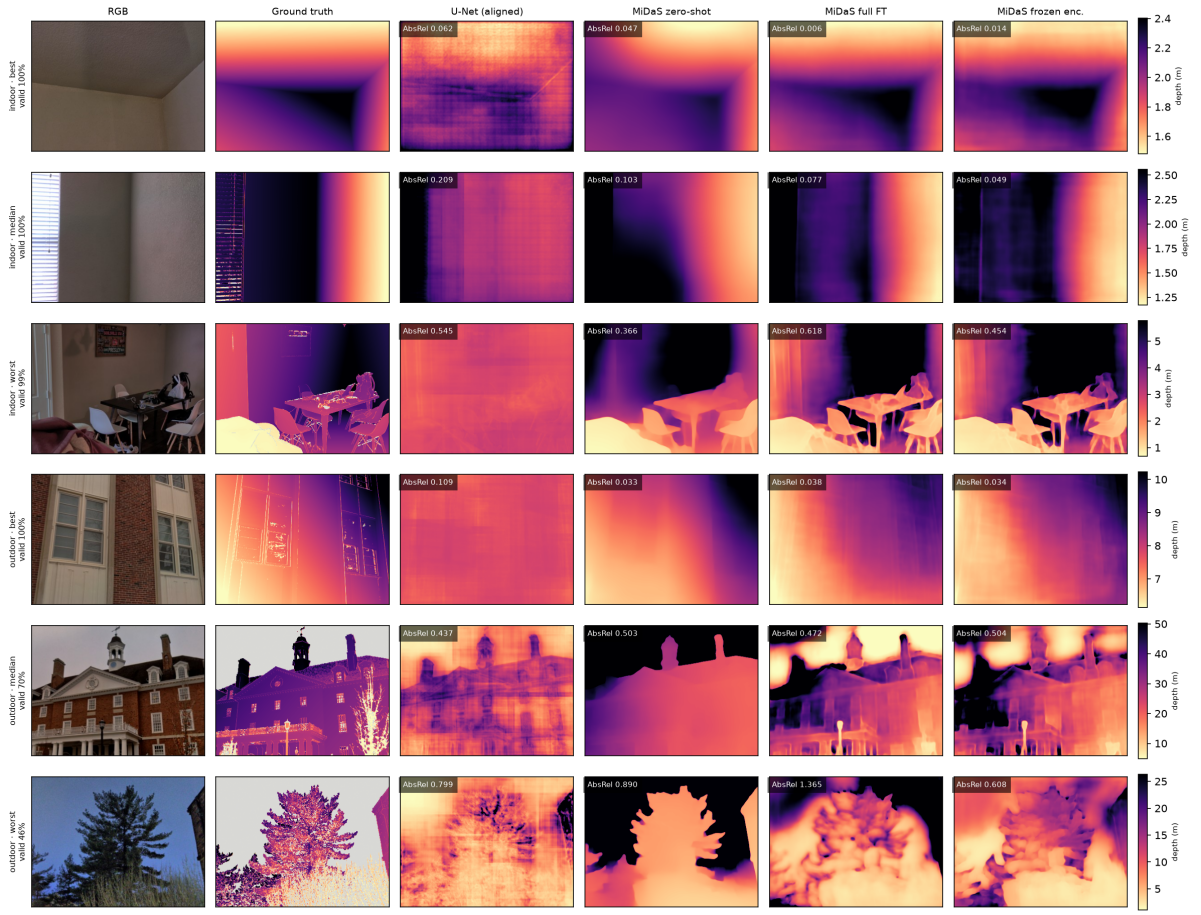


Figure 11: Test images ranked by MiDaS full-FT Abs Rel — best, median and worst per domain. Each row uses one colour scale (2nd–98th percentile of its GT; grey = invalid).

- **Correct, easy cases (rows 1, 4):** planar walls, ceilings and façades. All MiDaS variants reproduce the GT gradient (Abs Rel 0.006–0.047); the U-Net gets the global trend but shows a grid/checkerboard texture from transposed-convolution upsampling.

- **Difficult but correct (row 2, row 5):** a window with blinds and a building façade with sky. Full FT and frozen keep the wall-to-window depth step that zero-shot smooths over; on the façade, fine-tuned models recover the roof line and windows, while zero-shot collapses the building to a near-constant depth (Abs Rel 0.503 vs 0.472).

- **Failures (rows 3, 6):** the worst indoor image (a cluttered room with chairs and a blanket at < 1 m) and the worst outdoor image (a pine tree against sky, 46 % valid pixels). Full FT produces sharper object outlines than zero-shot but places the near blanket and the tree crown at the wrong relative depth, giving Abs Rel 0.618 and 1.365; the frozen encoder is better on both (0.454, 0.608).

3.4 Comparison and Discussion

- **Pretrained vs scratch (E1, supported).** On test, MiDaS zero-shot already beats the aligned U-Net overall (0.271 vs 0.305, -11 %) and indoors (0.126 vs 0.177, -29 %) without seeing DIODE; outdoors the two are tied (0.524 vs 0.531). The U-Net costs 2.7× fewer parameters and is 3× faster (3.3 vs ≈ 10 ms) but needs 52 min of training and still overfits (§3.1). Its **raw metric** error (test 0.561, val 0.671) is about twice its aligned error: most of the raw error is a global scale error, consistent with the val indoor scene being twice as close as the training rooms (§1.3).

- **Fine-tuning vs zero-shot (E2, supported).** Full FT lowers test Abs Rel from 0.271 to 0.232 (-14 %): indoor 0.126 → 0.096 (-24 %, δ_1 83.9 → 89.8 %) and outdoor 0.524 → 0.470 (-10 %). On val the outdoor gain is only 0.651 → 0.637; the val outdoor scene (a forest, 47 % invalid pixels) is much harder than the other outdoor scenes (§3.5, E-1).

- **Full FT vs frozen encoder (E3, controlled).** Over three seeds, full fine-tuning has lower **val** Abs Rel (0.2893 ± 0.0010 vs 0.2994 ± 0.0006). The gap of 0.0101 is about 10× the larger seed std, and every full-FT seed beats every frozen seed, so by the pre-registered decision criterion **full FT is better on val, and the hypothesis is supported**. The gain is entirely indoor (0.0909 vs 0.1053, -14 %); outdoors the two are within one std (0.637 vs 0.639). On the untouched **test** split the gap shrinks to 0.0024 (0.2310 vs 0.2334), about 1.4× the larger std: still in favour of full FT indoors (0.0943 vs 0.0994, all three seeds) and slightly worse outdoors (0.470 vs 0.468, within one std). Updating the encoder therefore helps mainly in indoor scenes, where DIODE's close-range laser geometry differs most from MiDaS's training data; outdoors the frozen ImageNet/MiDaS features are already as good as what 10 epochs of encoder updates can reach. Three seeds give only a rough std estimate, so the test-split conclusion is weak.

- **Accuracy–cost trade-off.** The frozen encoder uses **52 % less peak VRAM** (1.17 vs 2.42 GB) and trains **15 % faster** (30.1 vs 35.6 min) for the same inference cost. The U-Net is the only option under ≈ 5 ms/image, at +31 % test Abs Rel relative to fine-tuned MiDaS.

- **Hypotheses not yet supported / conclusions we cannot draw.** With one val and one test scene per domain, the outdoor ranking depends on scene content; the val→test

differences (e.g. outdoor 0.637 → 0.470 for full FT) are larger than any difference between the MiDaS variants. Aligned numbers measure relative depth only; none of the MiDaS variants produces metric depth on its own.

3.5 Error Analysis

Numbers in this section are on the **test split** for MiDaS full FT unless stated; per-image values are produced by `scripts/report/per_image_test.py` (not stored in git).

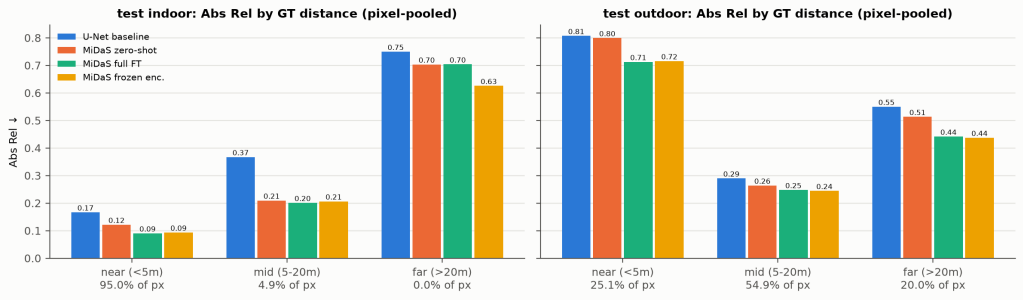


Figure 12: Test Abs Rel by ground-truth distance bin (pixel-pooled); x-labels give each bin's share of valid pixels.

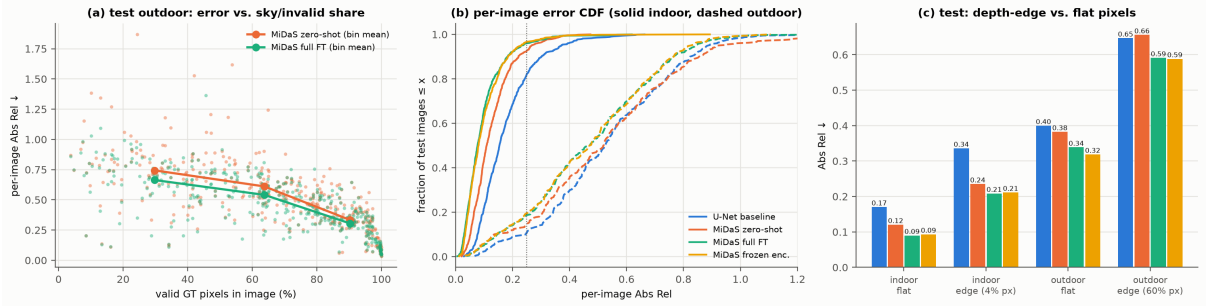


Figure 13: (a) Outdoor per-image Abs Rel vs share of valid GT pixels; (b) cumulative distribution of per-image Abs Rel (solid indoor, dashed outdoor); (c) Abs Rel on depth-edge vs flat pixels.

Table 9: Error taxonomy.

Group	Description	Frequency / rate	Examples	Hypothesised cause	Improvement ideas
E-1 Sky / sparse-GT outdoor images	Outdoor images whose valid pixels are fragmented by sky and foliage have far higher error	Spearman $\rho = -0.75$ between per-image Abs Rel and valid share. Images with $< 50\,\%$ valid pixels: 115 / 400 (29 %), mean Abs Rel **0.664**; images with $> 75\,\%$ valid: 180 / 400, mean **0.305** (Fig. 13a)	Fig. 11 row 6 (tree, 46 % valid, Abs Rel 1.365)	Remaining valid pixels are mostly thin branches next to sky, where laser returns are noisy; the global alignment is fitted on few, scattered pixels	Sky segmentation or confidence-weighted loss; erode boundary pixels in training targets; more outdoor scenes

Group	Description	Frequency / rate	Examples	Hypothesised cause	Improvement ideas
E-2 Depth discontinuities and thin structures	Pixels next to a depth jump ($> 10\,\%$ relative) or an invalid pixel	Indoor: 4.0 % of pixels, Abs Rel **0.208 vs 0.090** on flat pixels (2.3×). Outdoor: 60 % of pixels are edge pixels, **0.591 vs 0.339** (Fig. 13c)	Chair legs and table edges in Fig. 11 row 3; branches in row 6	All models output smooth maps at 384 × 288; GT at edges mixes foreground and background returns ("edge bleeding")	Higher input resolution; gradient-matching loss (as in MiDaS training); boundary-aware evaluation
E-3 Outdoor range compression	After alignment, near outdoor ground is predicted too far and far trees/buildings too close	Outdoor near (< 5 m, 25 % of px): Abs Rel **0.712**; mid (5–20 m, 55 %): **0.248**; far (> 20 m, 20 %): **0.441**, δ_1 only 23 % (Fig. 12)	Foreground grass in Fig. 11 row 6	A single scale/shift cannot fit a prediction whose depth ordering is only weakly correlated with GT (rank correlation 0.14 on val scene 00017 vs ≈ 0.45 on other outdoor scenes); errors are pulled toward the mid range	Train with a metric head or per-region alignment; more far-range training data
E-4 Indoor long views (doorways, corridors)	Few indoor pixels beyond 5 m are poorly predicted	4.9 % of indoor test pixels are 5–20 m: Abs Rel **0.201** vs 0.090 for < 5 m. Level-camera images (tilt 000, $n = 110$) mean **0.128** vs 0.078–0.082 for tilts 030–050	Corridors and open doors in scene 00000	Training rooms are close-range (median 2.6 m); level views include more distant corridor depth	Balance training images by depth range or add corridor-heavy scenes
E-5 U-Net global scale error and artefacts	Raw U-Net output has the wrong absolute scale; checkerboard texture	Raw → aligned test Abs Rel **0.561** → **0.305**; indoor 0.436 → 0.177	Fig. 11 column 3 (grid pattern)	Metric scale learned from 11 scenes does not transfer to closer/farther unseen rooms; transposed convolutions	Pretrained encoder; bilinear upsampling + conv; scale augmentation with camera intrinsics
E-6 Fine-tuning regressions	Some images get worse after fine-tuning	Full FT is worse than zero-shot on **25.9 %** of indoor and **24.8 %** of outdoor test images	Fig. 11 rows 3 and 6 (0.618 vs 0.366; 1.365 vs 0.890)	Overfitting the decoder to 11 training scenes; SSI loss ignores how bad individual outliers are	Fewer epochs or lower lr for the decoder; mix in original MiDaS training data; model averaging over seeds

Ablation E4a — boundary-mask erosion (val). Eroding the valid mask by 1 / 2 px (8-neighbourhood) removes pixels bordering invalid regions.

Table 10: Ablation E4a: aligned val Abs Rel under valid-mask erosion.

Model	Outdoor 0 px	1 px	2 px	Indoor 0 px → 2 px
U-Net (aligned)	0.641	0.456	0.435	0.165 → 0.163
MiDaS zero-shot	0.651	0.446	0.422	0.132 → 0.129
MiDaS full FT	0.637	0.432	**0.403**	0.091 → 0.089
MiDaS frozen enc.	0.637	0.432	0.405	0.106 → 0.104

Outdoor Abs Rel drops by 29–37 % while indoor changes by ≤ 0.003, so **a large part of the outdoor error sits on one- or two-pixel boundary bands** where the laser ground truth itself is unreliable (hypothesis E4a supported). Even after erosion, outdoor error is $\approx 4.5\times$ indoor (0.403 vs 0.089), so outdoor scenes remain harder, and the model ranking (full FT < frozen < zero-shot < U-Net) becomes clearer.

Ablation E4b — alignment method. Replacing least squares with a robust median / mean-absolute-deviation alignment makes every model worse (test, full FT: indoor 0.096 → 0.204; outdoor 0.470 → 2.001). In outdoor scenes the disparity distribution is dominated by near-zero values of far pixels, so matching medians and spreads and then inverting amplifies errors in the far range. Hypothesis E4b is rejected; least squares is kept. A separate check (`scripts/report/outdoor_check.py`) found that log-space alignment is also worse (val outdoor 0.89), and that MiDaS zero-shot scores 0.36–0.55 on the six training outdoor scenes vs 0.68 on val scene 00017, confirming the high outdoor val error is a property of that scene rather than a pipeline bug.

3.6 Limitations, Generalisation and Future Work

- **Data:** val and test each contain one indoor and one outdoor scene, so per-domain numbers reflect two specific scenes; the 0.637 (val) vs 0.470 (test) outdoor gap for the same checkpoint shows how strongly results depend on scene choice. All splits come from DIODE's training partition, so numbers are not comparable to the public benchmark.
- **Ground truth:** laser drop-outs and edge bleeding (§3.5, E-1, E-2, E4a) put a floor under outdoor error that no model removes.
- **Method:** aligned evaluation uses GT to fix scale and shift, so it measures relative structure rather than deployable metric depth. Only MiDaS_small was studied due to the 8 GB laptop GPU.
- **Experimental:** checkpoints are selected on val; to limit optimism, every main number is also reported on the untouched test split. The controlled experiment and the U-Net baseline use three seeds (42, 43, 44), so std estimates are still rough; Table 5 itself shows seed 42 only (zero-shot is deterministic and needs no seeds). Ten epochs may under-train the frozen variant (its seed-43 best epoch is the last one).
- **Resolution:** 384 × 288 inputs smooth thin branches and wires.
- **Future work:** a metric-depth head (or metric-depth pretrained models such as ZoeDepth / Depth Anything metric) to remove the alignment step; gradient-matching and edge-aware losses; sky masking; more outdoor scenes and cross-validation over scenes.

3.7 Conclusion

Does large-scale pretraining with a documented fine-tuning protocol beat a model trained from scratch for monocular depth on DIODE, and is updating the encoder worth its cost?

Yes for pretraining: fine-tuned MiDaS_small reaches test Abs Rel 0.232 (δ_1 72.7 %) against 0.305 (59.0 %) for the aligned U-Net and 0.271 for zero-shot MiDaS, with the largest gains indoors (0.096 vs 0.177). For the encoder question, updating the encoder is worth it by our decision criterion: over three seeds full fine-tuning beats the frozen encoder by 0.010 val Abs Rel ($\approx 10\times$ the seed std), almost entirely indoors. On test the advantage shrinks to 0.002 ($\approx 1.4\times$ std), so when memory is the constraint the frozen encoder is a reasonable choice: it gives up little accuracy for 52 % less peak VRAM and

15 % less training time. Outdoor scenes stay the main failure mode (test Abs Rel ≈ 0.47 for every MiDaS variant); erosion and per-image analysis show that a large part of this error comes from sparse, noisy laser ground truth at sky and foliage boundaries rather than from the models alone.

4 AI Usage Disclosure

In accordance with Sections 5.1 and 5.2 of the CO3133 Course Handbook, this section records the AI tools reported by the three members of Group CR7, their purposes, affected work, verification, and sources. The group also maintains a detailed disclosure record with all thirdteen log entries in `assignment2/AI_USAGE.md`; the entry numbers below refer to that file.

4.1 Group Member Roles and AI Usage Overview

Table 11: Group contributions, reported AI use, and verification responsibilities.

Member	**Assignment contributions**	**AI tools reported**	**Verification role**
Trần Hoàng Vỹ Khang (2352502)	Subset creation on Kaggle, scene-level split and scene manifest, data pipeline, seeds and configs, repository and checkpoint instructions.	Claude Code CLI (Claude Opus 5); log entries 9–10.	Verified split disjointness, mask format, resampling fix and subset statistics; reviewed the final report.
Đỗ Đăng Khoa (2352554)	Data verification, EDA, compute benchmark, visualisation, MiDaS evaluation review, error analysis, assignment page, final report.	Antigravity AI Assistant (Gemini / Claude models), log entries 1–8 and 13; Claude Code VS Code extension (Claude Opus 5.5), log entry 14.	Primary verifier of EDA statistics, figures, run artefacts and every number in this report.
Dương Đăng Khoa (2352551)	U-Net and MiDaS implementation, SILog/SSI losses, depth metrics, trainer, controlled-experiment design.	Antigravity AI Assistant; log entries 11–12.	Verified loss formulas, metric definitions, model shapes and parameter counts via unit tests; reviewed the final report.

4.2 Detailed Disclosure Entries

The entries below summarise the reported AI assistance and verification process. Each entry records the tool, user, stage, purpose, affected work, representative prompts or log location, treatment of AI output, responsible verification, and verification sources.

4.2.1 Entry 1: Review of M1 Data Validation, Visualisation and EDA

- **Tool and model:** Antigravity AI Assistant (Gemini / Claude model).
- **Member and stage:** Đỗ Đăng Khoa (2352554), M1 Proposal data exploration, 04 October 2026.
- **Purpose and category:** Data validation, debugging and coding-optimisation review; the member applied all changes manually.
- **Affected work:** `src/data/dataset.py`, `scripts/data/check_dataset.py`, `scripts/benchmark_midas.py`, `scripts/data/visualize_samples.py`, `scripts/data/eda.py`. Report Sections 1.2–1.3 and Figures 1–4.
- **Representative prompts and log:** Questions on whether DIODE `depth_mask.npy` is 0/1 or boolean, why `torch.hub.load` hangs in a non-interactive run, how to scale depth colour maps without one noisy pixel dominating, and how to compute percentiles over 7,195 depth maps without exhausting RAM. Recorded as log entries 1–4 in `AI_USAGE.md`.
- **Editing and verification:** The member converted masks explicitly to `uint8` and added the 50 m / 200 m depth caps, added `trust_repo=True` to the MiDaS benchmark, set the colour-map upper bound to the per-image 99th percentile, and rewrote EDA to accumulate per-image statistics scene by scene. Mask values were confirmed to be strictly $\{0, 1\}$ on 100 samples, the benchmark was re-run on the RTX 4060, the figures were inspected visually, and the EDA CSV was checked for 7,195 rows.
- **Responsible verification:** Đỗ Đăng Khoa (2352554).
- **Verification sources:** DIODE devkit documentation; PyTorch `Dataset` and `torch.hub` documentation; Matplotlib colour-map documentation; local terminal logs and generated CSV files.

4.2.2 Entry 2: Review of M1 Experiment Design, Leakage Check, SILog Formula and Page Structure

- **Tool and model:** Antigravity AI Assistant.
- **Member and stage:** Đỗ Đăng Khoa (2352554), M1 Proposal design and documentation, 04 October 2026.
- **Purpose and category:** Experiment-design review, leakage check, concept and formula check, and report-structure compliance check.
- **Affected work:** `proposal/scenes_used.csv`, `scripts/data/export_scenes.py`, `assignment2/index.html` (proposal sections). Report Sections 1.4, 2.2.1 and 2.4.
- **Representative prompts and log:** Requests to check whether the frozen-vs-full controlled experiment isolates one factor, whether any scene appears in more than one split, whether the SILog formula in the proposal is correct, and whether the assignment page contains all required sections. Recorded as log entries 5–8.

- **Editing and verification:** The member confirmed the controlled-experiment matrix against the handbook, ran a Python set-intersection check (0 common scenes) and made `export_scenes.py` exit with an error on any overlap, cross-checked the SILog equation against Eigen et al. (2014), and reorganised the page sections by hand, checking the layout locally.
- **Responsible verification:** Đỗ Đăng Khoa (2352554).
- **Verification sources:** Course Handbook Sections 2.2, 18 and 21; Eigen et al. (2014); PyTorch reproducibility documentation; DIODE metadata.

4.2.3 Entry 3: Proposal Compliance Review against Handbook Sections 18 and 21

- **Tool and model:** Claude Code CLI, using Claude Opus 5.
- **Member and stage:** Trần Hoàng Vỹ Khang (2352502), M1 Proposal compliance review, 05 October 2026.
- **Purpose and category:** Compliance and architecture review; no direct code modification.
- **Affected work:** `scripts/data/export_scenes.py`, `proposal/scenes_used.csv`; dataset version, license, split provenance, scene manifest, hypothesis and decision-criterion items of `assignment2/index.html`. Report Sections 1.2, 1.4 and 2.4.
- **Representative prompts and log:** Requests on how to choose the A2 dataset, whether the A2 branch was ready to merge, and whether the proposal covered every item of Sections 18 and 21. Recorded as log entry 9; the full transcript is kept locally by the member.
- **Editing and verification:** The review flagged four gaps: missing dataset version and license, an undocumented subset rule (26,229 $\rightarrow$ 7,195 images), an uncommitted `scenes_used.csv`, and a missing quantitative decision criterion. The member verified the MIT license on diode-dataset.org, the official devkit and the Kaggle mirror (Version 8), updated the proposal, and generated `scenes_used.csv` with zero scene overlap.
- **Responsible verification:** Trần Hoàng Vỹ Khang (2352502).
- **Verification sources:** diode-dataset.org; `diode-dataset/diode-devkit`; Vasiljevic et al. (2019); Course Handbook Sections 18, 19.6, 20, 21 and 22.

4.2.4 Entry 4: Subset Pipeline Review and Diagnosis of Bilinear Depth Resampling

- **Tool and model:** Claude Code CLI, using Claude Opus 5.
- **Member and stage:** Trần Hoàng Vỹ Khang (2352502), M1 Proposal subset reproducibility review, 05 October 2026.
- **Purpose and category:** Data-pipeline review and debugging; no direct code modification.
- **Affected work:** `scripts/data/make_subset.py`, `scripts/data/kaggle_diagnose.py`, `notebooks/monocular-depth-estimation.ipynb`; subset rule, resampling and EDA items of `assignment2/index.html`. Report Sections 1.3, 1.5 and 3.1.

- **Representative prompts and log:** A request to review the Kaggle subset notebook, its sampling rule and the depth/mask resize operations. Recorded as log entry 10; the full transcript is kept locally by the member.
- **Editing and verification:** The review found that depth was resized with `cv2.INTER_LINEAR` while the mask used `cv2.INTER_NEAREST`, so zero-encoded invalid pixels were blended into valid boundary depths. The member switched depth resizing to nearest neighbour, rebuilt the 7,195-image subset on Kaggle, confirmed mask values $\{0, 1\}$ and border-to-interior depth median ratios of 0.81–1.03, and re-ran the EDA.
- **Responsible verification:** Trần Hoàng Vỹ Khang (2352502).
- **Verification sources:** The group's Kaggle notebook; the Kaggle DIODE mirror (Version 8); OpenCV `cv2.resize` documentation; Course Handbook Sections 18 and 22.

4.2.5 Entry 5: Review of the Loss Functions and Depth Metrics Engine

- **Tool and model:** Antigravity AI Assistant.
- **Member and stage:** Dương Đăng Khoa (2352551), M2 Draft, 24 October 2026.
- **Purpose and category:** Implementation review, edge-case validation and test design.
- **Affected work:** `src/engine/loss.py`, `src/engine/metrics.py`, `tests/test_metrics.py`. Report Sections 2.2.1 and 2.2.5.
- **Representative prompts and log:** A request to check whether returning `pred.sum() * 0.0` for an all-invalid batch keeps the autograd graph, and to suggest a scale-invariance test for SILog. Recorded as log entry 11.
- **Editing and verification:** The member implemented `MaskedSILogLoss`, `compute_depth_metrics` and `DepthMetricTracker`, and wrote and ran tests covering gradient flow, empty masks, NaN/Inf handling and exact metric values on ground-truth input.
- **Responsible verification:** Dương Đăng Khoa (2352551).
- **Verification sources:** Eigen et al. (2014); PyTorch Autograd documentation; Course Handbook Section 20.1.

4.2.6 Entry 6: Review of the Baseline U-Net and Training Pipeline

- **Tool and model:** Antigravity AI Assistant.
- **Member and stage:** Dương Đăng Khoa (2352551), M2 Draft, 24 October 2026.
- **Purpose and category:** Architecture review and training-pipeline review.
- **Affected work:** `src/models/unet.py`, `src/engine/trainer.py`, `configs/baseline_unet.yaml`, `train.py`, `tests/test_models.py`, `tests/test_pipeline.py`. Report Sections 2.2.1 and 2.3.

- **Representative prompts and log:** A request to review the 4-level U-Net for 288×384 depth maps, AMP `GradScaler` use, the best-checkpoint rule on Abs Rel, and a synthetic end-to-end test. Recorded as log entry 12.
- **Editing and verification:** The member implemented the U-Net, trainer, YAML config and training CLI, verified the 7.76 M parameter count, and ran the synthetic pipeline test to confirm loss decrease, history logging and checkpoint saving.
- **Responsible verification:** Dương Đăng Khoa (2352551).
- **Verification sources:** Ronneberger et al. (2015); PyTorch AMP documentation; Course Handbook Section 20.

4.2.7 Entry 7: M2 Architecture Control, Code Review and Evaluation Verification

- **Tool and model:** Antigravity AI Assistant (Claude model).
- **Member and stage:** Đỗ Đăng Khoa (2352554), M2 Draft, 26 October 2026.
- **Purpose and category:** Architecture control, code review of Entries 5–6, and diagnostic verification; no direct code modification.
- **Affected work:** `src/engine/`, `src/models/`, `src/utils/common.py`, `src/data/dataset.py`, `configs/*.yaml`, `train.py`, `evaluate.py`, `run_all.sh`, `tests/`, `scripts/report/`. Report Sections 2.2–2.3 and 3.1.
- **Representative prompts and log:** A request to read the source code, review the architecture and find any part of the M2 pipeline that was not rigorous or deviated from the handbook. Recorded as log entry 13.
- **Editing and verification:** The review flagged five issues: metrics dropped non-positive predictions instead of clamping them; the U-Net needed an exp(clamp(·)) log-depth output instead of ReLU; the frozen encoder's BatchNorm layers had to stay in eval mode; MiDaS relative disparity required the SSI loss and per-image least-squares alignment; and sub-0.6 m scanner readings distorted outdoor error. The member implemented the fixes, wrote and ran the unit tests, verified identical results across repeated smoke runs, and executed all four configurations plus the erosion and per-scene diagnostics on the RTX 4060.
- **Responsible verification:** Đỗ Đăng Khoa (2352554).
- **Verification sources:** Ranftl et al. (2020); Eigen et al. (2014); Vasiljevic et al. (2019); PyTorch reproducibility and AMP documentation.

4.2.8 Entry 8: M3 Compliance Check, Final Runs, Figures and Report Draft

- **Tool and model:** Claude Code (VS Code extension), using Claude Opus 5.5.
- **Member and stage:** Đỗ Đăng Khoa (2352554), M3 Final, 09 November 2026.
- **Purpose and category:** Handbook compliance check of the A2 deliverables, experiment orchestration, figure generation and report drafting.

- **Affected work:** `scripts/report/report_figures.py` and `scripts/report/per_image_test.py` (new, written by the tool); seed-43/44 runs and test-split evaluation launched with the group's unchanged `train.py` and `evaluate.py`; `assets/a2_*.png` (Figures 5–13); first draft of this report and its LaTeX version; `index.html`, `.gitignore`, `requirements.txt`.
- **Representative prompts and log:** *"đọc kĩ mô tả bài tập lớn handbook-V2 và coi btl2 ass2 tôi đã đủ chưa"* (read the handbook carefully and check whether Assignment 2 is complete); *"tương tự ass1 bạn làm giúp tôi gen ảnh đồ ra rồi viết md report hoàn chỉnh dựa trên yêu cầu"* (as in Assignment 1, generate the figures and write a complete Markdown report following the requirements). Recorded as log entry 14.
- **Editing and verification:** Every number in the report was cross-checked against `outputs/*/eval_{val,test}.json`, `train_summary.json`, `history.csv` and `outputs/diagnostics/`; every figure was inspected visually; the group edited the wording and confirmed the interpretations in Sections 3.4–3.5. No model, loss, metric, data or training code was changed by the tool, and no result was produced outside the group's own runs.
- **Responsible verification:** Đỗ Đăng Khoa (2352554), with review by Trần Hoàng Vỹ Khang (2352502) and Dương Đăng Khoa (2352551).
- **Verification sources:** Saved run outputs; Course Handbook Sections 3, 4 and 17–23; Ranftl et al. (2020); Vasiljevic et al. (2019).

4.3 Declaration

The group declares that the dataset choice, scene-level split, model implementations, controlled-experiment design and conclusions are the group's own work, and that every reported number comes from runs executed on group hardware. All AI-assisted code, figures and text were reviewed and verified by the responsible members as described above. The group accepts that the instructor may interview any member and request explanation, live edits, metric interpretation or partial reproduction (Handbook Section 5.5).